DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL JANKIPURAM, LUCKNOW

SESSION 2025 - 2026 : PRE BOARD 1

ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (184)

SET I

MM: 80 **Time: 3 Hrs**

Date: _____ **Name** _____ **Class: X Sec:** _____

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

1. This Question Paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The Question Paper contains THREE sections-
   - Section A : Reading Skills
   - Section B : Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
   - Section C : Literature Textbook
3. Attempt all questions based on specific instructions for each part.

Section A : Reading Skills (20 marks)

1. Read the passage and answer the questions that follow. **(10)**

1.Nature is our mother, our first teacher. The greatest lesson that she teaches us is to maintain an equilibrium in life. We learn to maintain composure through our joys, sorrows and fears. In fact, there are a thousand lessons that nature can teach us, provided we look for them.

2. With time, a sapling grows into a full-grown tree; something so tiny and delicate develops into a strong tree capable of supporting others. No matter how tall it grows, how much it may flourish, or how many animals and birds it may support, its roots are firmly buried from where it once rose. That's a lesson - to keep ourselves grounded, respect and embrace our roots, and give something back to those humble beginnings that nurtured us into who we are.

3. Then there is the message of peaceful coexistence. 'I am because we are.' Nature provides every creature a chance to exist. However, the existence of one creature or being depends on the existence of the other. The tiger eats the antelope; without the antelope, the tiger wouldn't survive. Likewise, without tigers, the over-abundance of antelopes would cause them to starve to death.

4. I wonder if you have noticed that when birds or squirrels see a predator, they give out an alarm call to their fellow creatures, of the lurking danger. They put themselves in danger to save the lives of others. Many animals, like the salmon, usually die after they spawn, but this doesn't stop them. One life extinguished for the betterment of others is a small price to pay.

5. The snow melts in the warmth of spring to give birth to fresh green leaves. In autumn these leaves age into shades of gold only to be buried in the cold grave of winter. Change is inevitable; the sooner we embrace this, the better it is for us. We must also understand that even in pain there is growth. If you cut a hole in the tree, it will grow around it. No matter what may come in its way, a river will continue to flow. Similarly, no matter what grief may break your heart, nature teaches us that life goes on.

6. Keep in mind life isn't about making lists and trying to be one step ahead of others. Life is to live. Take a break-stop being a workaholic, and smell the roses, do whatever makes you feel happy and most of all spend some time with nature to pick up invaluable lessons.

(419 words)

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the given questions by choosing the correct option.

I. According to the author, what, from the following, is the greatest lesson being taught by nature? **(1)**

A. To be balanced in our emotions. B. partial to joys in life

C. Should be afraid of unhappiness. D. indifferent to fears.

II. Select the option that suitably completes the dialogue with reference to paragraph 2. **(1)**

Jai: I've done well for myself in this school. I'm the best they have. I can get admission anywhere. This is my moment!

Sid: Congratulations! Just remember, we should .....

A. become strong despite our weakness.

B. be kind and supportive towards everyone.

C. respect the origins from where we have grown.

D. nurture ourselves well from the beginning.

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III. Choose the option that best conveys the message in - 'I am because we are.' (1)

A. Tigers are dependent on antelope
B. Antelope are dependent on tigers
C. Humans are dependent on animals
D. Everyone is dependent on each other

IV. What qualities do the birds and squirrels display when they warn others of possible danger? (2)

V. A Portmanteau words like smog (smoke + fog), is a blend of words in which parts of multiple words are combined into a new word. (1)

From the options given below, select a Portmanteau word that appears in the para VI.

A. coexistence
B. workaholic
C. full-grown
D. flourish

VI. Select the qualities from paragraph III, that the author wants us to imbibe.Being (1)

(1) acceptive (2) passionate (3) emotional (4) resilient (5) perceptive

A. (2), (4) and (5)
B. (1), (3) and (4)
C. (1), (4) and (5)
D. (3), (4) and (5)

VII. Which of the following is shown by the changing of seasons? (1)

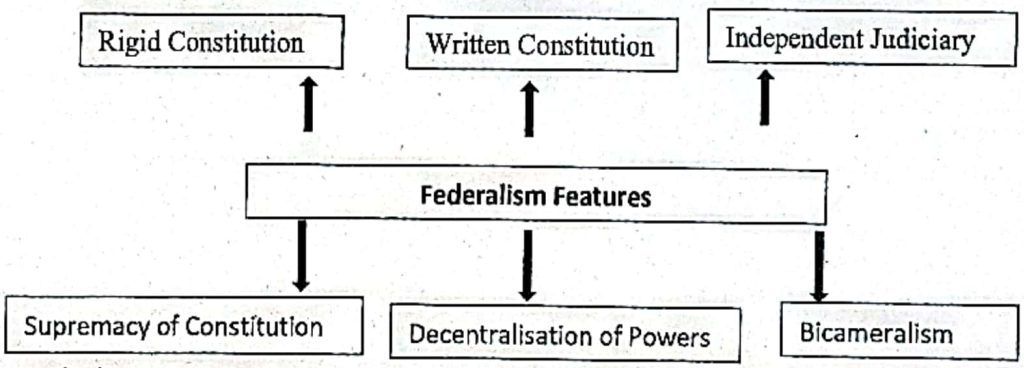
A. The beauty of nature.
B. Nature's creativity.
C. All seasons are equal.
D. Nothing lasts forever.

VIII. What does the writer advise, in paragraph 6? (2)

2. Read the following passage carefully [10]

1. Federalism in India is a complex system of governance characterised by the division of powers between the Central Government and the states. The roots of federalism in India can be traced back to the colonial era when the British Raj implemented a centralised administrative structure. However, the demand for greater autonomy by regional leaders and the diversity of India's cultural, linguistic and geographical landscape necessitated a shift towards a federal system after independence in 1947.

2. The Constitution of India, adopted in 1950, enshrines federal principles by delineating powers between the Union Government and the states in the Seventh Schedule. Key features include a dual polity, with both the Union and states having their spheres of authority, as well as mechanisms for resolving disputes through the judiciary and inter-governmental forums.



3. Despite its federal structure, Indian federalism faces several challenges. One major issue is the asymmetrical distribution of powers, with the Union Government wielding greater authority in certain areas, leading to tensions between the centre and states. Additionally, fiscal federalism remains a contentious issue, with states clamoring for greater financial autonomy and a fairer allocation of resources.

4. In conclusion, the case study highlights the dynamic nature of federalism in India, shaped historical legacies, constitutional provisions and ongoing debates. While federalism serves as a cornerstone of India's democratic governance, addressing its challenges requires continual dialogue, cooperation and adaptation to ensure a more equitable and responsive system of governance.

Answer the following questions based on your reading of the above passage.

1. Why did the Indian Constitution adopt a federal structure in 1950? (Paragraph 1) (1)

This is so because federalism suited .....

(a) British ideals of centralisation
(b) the limited power of Indian leaders

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(c) India's need for decentralisation due to its diversity
(d) global political pressures after independence

2. **Identify the phrase in paragraph 3 that highlights the unequal sharing of authority between the Union and the States.** (1)

3. **Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those given in the brackets. (Paragraph 2)** (1)

Federalism in India is supported by the..... (Parliament/Seventh Schedule), which outlines the division of responsibilities. To ensure a clear separation of powers between the Union and the States, the Indian Constitution includes a framework that assigns subjects under different lists.

4. **What is meant by 'dual polity' in the context of Indian federalism? (Paragraph 2)** (1)

5. **Complete the sentence with a logical inference.** (1)

Although the Constitution provides a federal structure, the Union Government's stronger authority results in .....

(a) reduced autonomy for state governments in key policy areas.
(b) increased participation of citizens in national-level decision-making.
(c) equal sharing of power between the Centre and the states.
(d) frequent changes in the structure of the Constitution.

6. **Complete the following sentence appropriately.** (1)

One way to make Indian federalism more effective is by encouraging ongoing ..... between the Centre and States. (Paragraph 4)

7. **What does the phrase 'dynamic nature of federalism' in paragraph 4 imply?** (1)

8. **What issue related to fiscal federalism is highlighted in the passage? (Paragraph 3)** (2)

9. **Fill in the blank with ONE suitable word. (Paragraph 2)** (1)

The Constitution, while establishing federalism, also ensures mechanisms for resolving ..... between the Union and States.

Section B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills (20 Marks)

Grammar

3. **Complete ANY TEN of twelve of the following tasks as directed.** **(10 X 1 = 10)**

(i) Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of the letter.

Subject: Complaint about a damaged product received
Sir/Ma'am
I purchased a black top from your online store. I..... (receive) the product today, and I tried filing a return request as the size is smaller than the one I had ordered and the cloth is torn on the left side.

(ii) Read the given sentence from an article. Identify the error and supply the correction in the sentence.

As we advance into the future, landmarks are sometimes unceremoniously destroyed by the tourist and the residents for their own selfish motives.

Use the given format for your response.

Error	Correction

(iii) Shreya asked for some information from the shopkeeper about the bike's price. Report her question.

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Shreya said to the shopkeeper, "What is the price of this bike?"

(iv) Read the dialogue between Dilip and Rohan.

Dilip: Why do you ask me to keep quiet whenever I say something?

Rohan: Have you ever said anything sensible?

Narrate Rohan's dialogue.

Dilip angrily asked Rohan why he asked him to keep quiet whenever he said something to which Rohan asked.....

(v) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the given statement.

He went there so that he ..... (may/might/should) borrow some money.

(vi) Fill in the blank with the correct form of verb given in the bracket.

If they ..... (leave) earlier, they would have caught the train.

(vii) Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line.

The princely states of Jammu and Kashmir triggered the first undeclared war with Pakistan.

Options	Error	Correction
(a)	triggered	Triggers
(b)	states	State
(c)	the first	first
(d)	Pakistan	the Pakistan

(viii) Complete the given narrative by filling in the blank with the correct option.

She ..... very worried for the past few days but when I asked what the matter was, she said that it was nothing.

(a) looked (b) had been looking (c) had looked (d) looks

(ix) Report the dialogue between Dilip and Rohan to complete the following sentence.

Dilip: I have been watching the sea and there hasn't been any trace of a ship.

Rohan: I told you yesterday too that we'll be rescued, so have patience.

Dilip said that he had been watching the sea and that there had not been any trace of a ship. Rohan replied that ..... that they would be rescued and asked him to have patience.

(x) Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the following sentence.

I ..... basketball quite well but I haven't had time to practice it since I came to Mumbai.

(a) will play (b) play (c) am playing (d) have played

(xi) Complete the line from a song by filling the blank with the correct option.

When you are feeling down

And all you..... muster up is a frown

That is the time to stop

And count your blessings until you drop.

(a) can (b) would (c) shall (d) must

(xii) Fill in the blank to complete the sentence in a teacher's diary by choosing the correct option.

There isn't .....time left to finish the activity.

(a) many (b) any (c) few (d) several

Writing

Note: All details presented in the questions in writing section are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

(10)

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4. **Attempt ANY ONE from A and B given below.** (5)

A. You are Rajni Verma, Hostel Warden, PVV Public School, Banaras, Uttar Pradesh. Write a letter to the Sales Manager, Bharat Electronics and Domestic Appliances Ltd., New Delhi placing an order for fans, microwaves, ovens and geysers that you wish to purchase for the hostel. Also, ask for discount permissible on the purchase. (100- 120 words)

OR

B. You have recently heard about a tragic death of student from North-East by suicide. The cause of his death is attributed to racial bullying. Write a letter in about 120 words to the Editor of Times of India, New Delhi expressing deep anguish as well as highlighting the need to address the issue of discrimination faced by people from North-East residing in other states.

5. **Attempt ANY ONE from A and B given below.** (5)

A. Read the points below from a feedback section of a government website regarding problems faced by physically disabled people.

- Absence of ramps for wheelchairs
- Unclean toilets
- Unsuitable visiting timings. Tourists guides untrained in sign language
- Lack of braille- script tourist pamphlets
- Lack of empathy from fellow visitors and officials

Based upon the given points, write an analytical paragraph in 100-120 words.

OR

B. Shyam, a class X student, is imaginative, good at visualising complex ideas and loves experimenting with digital tools. However, he finds it hard to stay organised and often misses deadlines. He needs to choose a partner for a multimedia science project presentation. Below are the profiles of three candidates.

Soni: Soni is extremely focussed and is always ahead of schedule. She is good at breaking tasks into manageable steps and is dependable. However, she prefers traditional methods and avoids trying new technologies.

Zoya: Zoya is creative and tech- savvy. She is open to experimentation and enjoys digital presentation. However, she tends to get distracted easily and dislikes following schedules.

Rahul: Rahul is calm and structured. He is tech- friendly and believes in teamwork. He likes trying new things but makes sure deadlines are met. However, he sometimes avoids taking initiatives unless prompted.

Based on the features of each candidate, analyse and decide who would be the best partner for Shyam. Consider aspects such a balanced teamwork, creativity, technical support and reliability.

Section C: Literature Textbook (40 Marks)

6. **Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the given two.** (5)

A. *Coorg or Kodagu, the smallest district of Karnataka, is home to evergreen rainforests, spices and coffee plantations. Evergreen rainforests cover thirty per cent of this district. During the monsoons, it pours enough to keep many visitors away. The season of joy commences from September and continues till March. The weather is perfect, with some showers thrown in for good measure. The air breathes of invigorating coffee. Coffee estates and colonial bungalows stand tucked under tree canopies in prime corners.*

(Coorg-Glimpses of India)

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(i) What do you understand by the term 'colonial bungalow' as described in the lines given below. (1)

Coffee estates and colonial bungalows stand tucked under tree canopies in prime corners.

(a) The bungalows built in a colony
(b) A large detached house with more than one storey.
(c) The residential unit for members of the British colonial community.
(d) A low house having only one storey.

(ii) Which is the best time to visit Coorg? Why? (2)

(iii) Categorise the following words from the extract into those related to natural features and human-made features. (1)

I. evergreen rainforests II. coffee plantations
III. colonial bungalows IV. Monsoons V. coffee estates

Options	Natural Features	Human- made Features
(a)	I, II and IV	III and V
(b)	I and IV	II, III and V
(c)	II, IV and V	I and III
(d)	I, III and IV	II and V

(iv) What can be inferred from the given line? (1)

"During the monsoons, it pours enough to keep many visitors away."

OR

B. ***He discovered the joys of being bowled over, tramped on and squashed every few minutes. He became an accepted member of the gang, an unlikely, silky little object among the shaggy crew, fighting like a tiger for his share at mealtimes and hunting rats in the old henhouse at night. He had never had such a time in his life. All the while, Mrs Pumphrey hovered anxiously in the background, ringing a dozen times a day for the latest bulletins.***

(A Triumph of Surgery)

(i) Why does the narrator describe being 'tramped on and squashed' as joys? (1)
(a) To suggest the irony about the strange ways of dogs
(b) To mention the simple pleasures of canine life
(c) To compare it to Tricki's earlier play-time at the house
(d) To direct attention towards Tricki's successful recovery

(ii) How did Tricki become an accepted member of the gang and start enjoying the company of other dogs? Answer in about 40 words. (2)

(iii) Select the option that correctly completes the following (1)

Mrs. Pumphrey's constant phone calls during Tricki's stay at the surgery show that she.....
(a) trusted the vet completely and wanted to thank him often.
(b) believed Tricki was enjoying too much and wanted him home.
(c) remained overly anxious and emotionally attached to Tricki.
(d) was unaware of Tricki's condition and needed frequent updates.

(iv) What does the reference to Tricki as a 'silky little object' signify? (1)

7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the given two. (5)

A. The way a crow
Shook down on me

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The dust of snow
From a hemlock tree
Has given my heart
A change of mood
And saved some part
Of a day I had rued. *(Dust of Snow)*

(i) What is the poet trying to appreciate through the given lines? (2)
(ii) Fill in the blank with ONE WORD. (1)

The poetic device used in the line '*and saved some part*' is .....
(iii) What was the reaction of the poet when the dust of snow fell on him? (1)
(iv) Choose the option showing the reason not corresponding with '..... a crow/shook down on me/The Dust of Snow.' (1)

(a) The crow's landing on the branch of the tree.
(b) The shivering of the crow due to the cold.
(c) The readjustment of the position of the crow on the branch.
(d) Both (a) and (c)

OR

B. *The fog comes on little cat feet.*
It sits looking over harbour and city on
silent haunches and then moves on. *(Fog)*

(i) How does the poet compare fog to a cat? (2)

(ii) Complete the following suitably. (1)
The word 'moves on' depicts ..... quality of fog.
(iii) Highlight any two characteristics of fog from its description in the poem. (1)
(iv) Why do you think 'Fog' is a free verse poem? (1)
I. It has only six lines. II. It is divided in two paragraphs.
III. It has no regular rhyme scheme. IV. It is rhyming abab.
Select the correct option
(a) Only I (b) Only III (c) Only IV (d) I and III

8. Answer ANY FOUR of the following five questions in about 40-50 words each. (4X3=12)
(i) Write the message that the poem 'Fire and Ice' gives. (3)
(ii) "All knowledge is useful. But not all knowledge is worth the cost." Elaborate on the quote in the context of the poem 'How to Tell Wild Animals'. (3)
(iii) Did the letter reach God? Why did the postmaster send a reply to Lencho? (3)
Refer to the given lines from the text
"What faith! I wish I had the faith of the man who wrote this letter. Starting up a correspondence with God!" (A Letter to God)

(iv) Why was the site called "a rainbow gathering of different colours and nations"? (Nelson Mandela- Long Walk to Freedom) (3)

(v) "This is a tea country now." Explain this with reference to Assam. (3)
(Tea from Assam- Glimpses of India)

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9. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions in about 40-50 words each. (2X3=6)

(i) Give any two reasons for Oop's breaking into laughter on reading the first nursery rhyme. (The Book that Saved the Earth) (3)

(ii) What kind of mother was Ramlal's wife? (Bholi) (3)

(iii) Mme Loisel now knew the horrible life of necessity. Do you think Mme. Loisel accepted this change willingly? Give two reasons in support of your answer. (The Necklace) (3)

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. (1x6=6)

A. Franklin D. Roosevelt said, "The only thing we have to fear is fear itself", Analyse how the idea of fear is dealt with in the stories 'Nelson Mandela- A long Walk to Freedom' and Two Stories About Flying'?

OR

B. "Man and animal relationships are based on trust and friendship." Explain by referring to the poem 'The Tale of a Custard Dragon' and 'Mijbil the Otter'?

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions in about 100-120 words. (1x6=6)

A. A calm mind can help you tackle the direst stress. Elaborate with reference to the story "The Midnight Visitor'.

OR

B. Discuss your thoughts and feelings after reading the story 'Footprints Without Feet' by H.G. Wells. How did the story impact your understanding of science and human nature? Explain the main themes of the story and the character of the Invisible Man, Griffin. What lessons did you learn from the story?

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